

WOOL MIX TWO-PIECE POWER SUIT

The “executive look”, which first found expression in the 1970s as part of the working woman’s wardrobe, matured by the mid-1980s into “power dressing”. This outfit, by French designer Thierry Mugler, combines a sharply accentuated, shoulder-padded jacket with a feminizing short skirt. The single-breasted jacket, in orange worsted wool and polyester mix, is fitted at the waist and rounded on the hips. The pencil skirt is knee length, straight, and made of black wool. The increasingly high profile of women in the workplace was reflected in their wardrobes. Suits were tailored, but used softer dressmaking padding to structure the shoulders than in traditional men’s suits. Accessorized with bold costume jewellery and stiletto heels, the look spoke of confidence and power.

Straight line
across the
shoulders

Close-fitting
skirt ends
above the knee

BOLD AND BRIGHT

Thierry Mugler tailors his suit to create a stylized feminine archetype: square shoulders, cinched waist, and full hips. Typically crafted in strong colours, this ensemble appeared thoroughly modern in its day. The short, buttock-hugging skirt invited attention but defied anyone to touch.

SIDE VIEW